'Round the Mountainside

Quarterly newsletter for Coolfont Mountainside Association

Summer 2021

President's Message

We are so fortunate to see all our new neighbors moving to the community, and I know that all of us on the CMA Board will be thrilled to meet and welcome our new community members at the CMA Annual Dinner on September 25th . This is a terrific event that we missed having last year due to the pandemic. This year's Annual Dinner will certainly allow us to relax and enjoy great food and each other's company.



You may have noticed by the emails, that we will have several open seats on the Board this year. Both Sharon and I have been thrilled to be part of this Board, and we hope that you will consider running for one of the openings. Being on the CMA Board allows you to use your talents to help make our community even better. After having served over four terms on the Board (separate occasions during the years), and two separate terms as President, I have been honored to work with my neighbors. Each term has been exciting for me, as I have learned so much from my fellow Board members.

I urge each of my neighbors to consider running for the Board this year or volunteering with one of our committees. We have so much work to be done at CMA, and it requires volunteers to help put plans into action. I look forward to seeing everyone at the Annual Meeting and Dinner!

Best, Jason Geno

Watch Your Inbox

In early September, CMA will be sending an email with information about the Annual Membership Meeting and Election.

It's very important that all owners/ members participate in online voting in order to obtain a meeting quorum.

Owners will elect four members to the CMA Board and cast their votes on the 2022 Proposed Budgets and other Association business.

Please be sure we have a current email address for your account.

UPCOMING EVENTS

Board of Directors Meeting	Saturday, August 28, 10:00 am	CMA Barn
Pool Closes for Season	Monday, September 6, at closing	CMA Pool
Annual Membership Meeting	Saturday, September 25, 10:00 am	CMA Barn
Annual Membership Dinner	Saturday, September 25, 6:00 pm	CMA Barn
Board of Directors Meeting	Saturday, October 9, 10:00 am	CMA Office or Barn
CMA Committee Meetings	November 2021	Date/Time set by Committee

Septic Maintenance: Tanks A Lot!

by Cathy Levey, Water/Sewer Chair

On January 1, 2021, a new Septic System Maintenance Policy went into effect after Board approval in 2020. The policy states that "owners of full-time occupied residences or residences regularly rented with a quarterly water usage in excess of 10,000 gallons, to have septic tanks pumped and inspected no less than once every three (3) years by a licensed septic system contractor." All other owners will have their septic tanks "pumped and inspected no less than once every five (5) years by a licensed septic system contractor."

At the start of 2021, the list of homeowners with septic tanks due to be pumped – based on the new policy – was 29, with five additional due around September 2021. Thanks to the support and cooperation of our homeowners, that list of 29 has been whittled down to only seven that are still due. The investment this makes in maintaining a healthy sewer system and lagoon cannot be overstated. To all of you who have responded so far this year (and in the past), we extend to you our sincerest thanks.

Should anyone feel their septic tank does not need to be pumped as frequently as indicated in the current Policy, please note there is a form called "Septic Maintenance Period Appeal" that can be completed and mailed/emailed to the CMAWS Secretary for the Board's consideration. The form is included with the Policy available on the CMA website [*See* Association/Governing Documents].

Finally, the project to locate all homeowners' septic tanks was completed last year, thanks to the help of numerous volunteers and professionals. Should you desire a copy of a map showing the location of your septic tanks, please contact the CMAWS chair, Cathy Levey at mccm2012@hotmail.com or 410-718-6716.

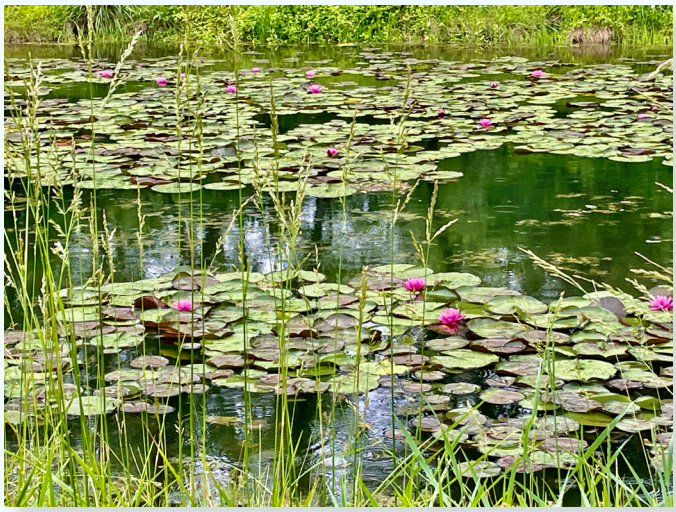


Save a Little $$$!

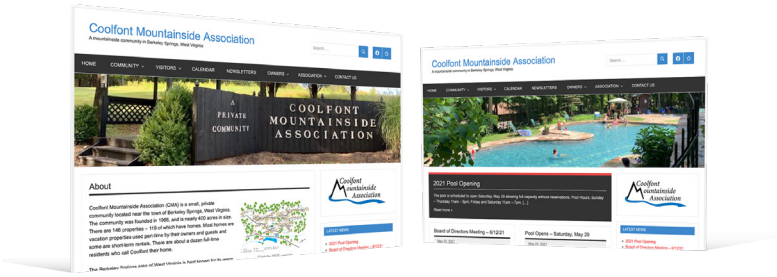
Just a reminder that Morgan County provides a nice discount (2.5%) if you pay your property taxes and fire and ambulance fees before September 1. For information on your tax bills and the early payment discount, contact the Morgan County Sheriff's Tax Office at 304-258-8562 or visit morgancountywv.gov/taxoffice.



Minor traffic jam on CRVRoad. Craig Deane, T-2



Water lilies on canal in Hancock, MD.
Joanie Zuckerman, T-6



CMA Website Update

by Website Committee

The CMA website received a major overhaul and update in June. It has all the same, great resources for owners and visitors - just a bit easier to find. We added a Search field, so you can quickly find the information you need. Latest News, Handy Contacts, and Quick Links are available on every page, providing direct access to those notices, contacts, and documents.

The Community menu is all about Coolfont Mountainside, its amenities, Firewise Program, and Latest News. Visitors to the site will find information about local area attractions and community rentals.

Newsletters are available for browsing and the Community Calendar lists upcoming events. The Owners' area still includes information about contracted services, suggested contractors, and a growing resource of community FAQs. Our governing documents are now available for propsective buyers in the Association menu, along with information and contacts for Committees and the Board.

You can also download forms for the DACC (modifications) and Firewise (volunteer hours, etc).

You'll find all this, and more, at:

www.coolfontmountainside.org

Behind the scenes, the site management has been streamlined, reCaptcha added (to reduce spam emails), and we're working to migrate to a more robust hosting service. Thank you to our content reviewers, editors, network gurus, and other volunteers for help with this project.

Please see the CMA Google Group for information about accessing the secure documents in the Owners section.

Nature Next Door

by Eunice Pryor, G-3



After sighting this beauty at the edge of the Cacapon State Park lodge parking lot, I took a small branch to photograph and bring home to Delaware. It turns out it is an Eastern hophornbeam[1] (*Ostrya virginiana*) tree, sometimes called Ironwood. We've been coming to the Berkeley Springs area for 44 years and this is the first time I've averted to it. I think the blossom is unusually attractive and elegant.

Extending my research, I investigated whether these trees are found here in Delaware. They are! But there are not many and one naturalist helped plant a pocket park with them but will give only broad directions as to where to see others. I'm still on the hunt and know I have a limited time until the blossoms drop.

During our years of coming to Coolfont, Mother Nature has consistently provided us with gifts such as this. The first was a small understory tree with little buds all along its branches. I thought I was seeing a lifetime first, but upon returning to Delaware learned that neighbors three doors down had such a tree, and of course over time have seen many more of these redbuds[2] (*Cercis canadensis*). They've now even developed a white blossomed variety (*Cercis canadensis var. alba*).

This is just a testimonial for Mother Nature and the many surprises and delights she has in store for us.

1. Eastern hophornbeam is a small tree that inhabits hardwood forests across the eastern United States, from northern Florida to southeastern Canada. The common name comes from the fruits that form papery clusters resembling the hops used in brewing beer.
2. Eastern redbud is a small genus of about six species of deciduous trees and shrubs that are distributed over a wide area across both coasts of North America to the Mediterranean and East Asia. Clusters of lavender-pink or white blossoms sprout right from the branches and trunks in early spring, soon followed by heart-shaped leaves.

The Role of Neighborhood Watch in the Community

by Cathy Levey, Chair, Neighborhood Watch

In May 2010, CMA Security Patrols were established by the board followed by a transition in 2017 to Neighborhood Watch Patrols. Neighborhood Watch, it was decided, more accurately represented what we as a community seek in making our community a true "community." A Neighborhood Watch program is defined as "a group of people living in the same area who want to make their neighborhood safer by working together and in conjunction with local law enforcement to reduce crime and improve their quality of life."

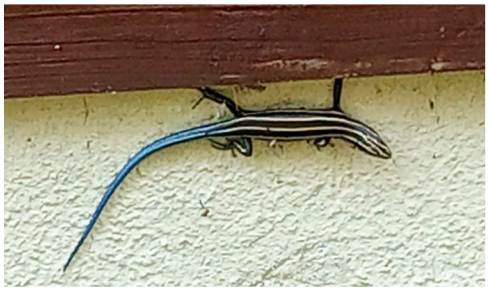
In establishing Neighborhood Watch (NW), every member of the community becomes a member of Neighborhood Watch and although not everyone opts to make patrols, each member of the community provides an additional set of eyes and ears to assist in ensuring the well being of all who reside here at CMA, whether a full-time resident, a part-time second homeowner, or the owner of a rental property. Those individuals who choose to make a greater investment by performing patrols, volunteer their time to provide a stronger presence in the community and a deeper level of vigilance.

If a safety concern is noted during a Neighborhood Watch patrol – such as a fallen tree on an owner's property, evidence of a water leak, property damage, or an insecure door or window – our volunteers will immediately notify the homeowner, as any good neighbor would do. If the property is a rental property, the homeowner is responsible for working with their rental agent (if any) to resolve the issue. NW volunteers are not responsible for enforcing rental guidelines. Should the NW patrol volunteer note site issues, such as trash or trash bin concerns, downed trees on roadways or common areas, or developing potholes, the site manager will be notified – again, as we hope any homeowner in the community can and should do.

Finally, the Neighborhood Watch volunteers are not responsible for covenants compliance (such as exterior maintenance on homes, outside security lights, etc.); DACC guidelines enforcement; noise violations; or issues related to rental concerns.

Those that volunteer to be a part of the Neighborhood Watch Patrols are inspired by a desire to give back to the community they love and to be a part of making their community a better place. They are not to be seen as a substitute for professional management.

A sincere thanks to all who choose to volunteer their time and efforts on behalf of our community.



A blue-tailed skink hanging out at Iris Melton's (K-12).



Sunshine, the Moore's (P-9) magnificent mouser. "I brought you a present!"

Grilling Fire Safety Tips

by Heidi Splane, Firewise Chair

- Only use grills outdoors, away from siding and deck railings.
- Clean grills often and remove grease or fat build-up.
- Make sure your gas grill lid is open before lighting.
- Have a 3-foot safe-zone around grills and campfires. Keep kids and pets away from the area.
- Dispose of coals after they have cooled in a metal can.
- Never leave grills, fire pits, and patio torches unattended.

Source: www.usfa.fema.gov



Outdoor fire safety video: https://youtu.be/v2k6rNOCrz4

FIREWISE WEST VIRGINIA



Attention Bird Lovers

Wildlife officials have recently announced they are receiving reports of a mysterious disease affecting certain types of birds in West Virginia. Officials from WV, VA, MD, the National Park Service are collaborating to investigate. Because birds congregate at bird feeders and birdbaths, they issued a recommendation that homeowners cease feeding birds until this infection can be resolved.

For the full story, please visit www.usgs.gov/news/updated-interagency-statement-usgs-and-partners-continue-investigating-dc-area-bird-mortality.

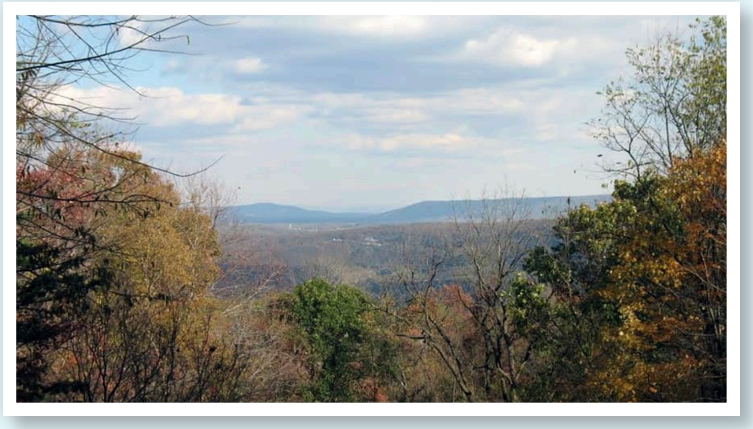


Female Ruby Throated Hummingbird - Iris Melton, K-12

Eidolon Nature Preserve

The Nature Conservancy and Potomac Valley Audubon Society

The 354-acre Eidolon Nature Preserve is located along the summit and east side of Sideling Hill, in Morgan County, West Virginia. The preserve features dense mountaintop forests, several ground-fed natural springs and commanding views of the Potomac River.



The Story



An old ridgetop property that was originally part of an 18th century Fairfax grant, this land belonged to the Zapoleon family for nearly 60 years. They named the property "Eidolon" which translated from Greek means "image of the ideal" and used it as a weekend and summer retreat.

During her time on the mountain, Mrs. Zapoleon recorded hand-written card files on the flora and fauna of Eidolon. Those card files have since been transcribed to a digital database. Mrs. Zapoleon also published a book on Eidolon titled *Everyone Needs a Mountain*.

It was the vision of the Zapoleon's that Eidolon be preserved as they had always known it; a place for the enjoyment and study of nature and for quiet contemplation. Therefore, Eidolon was willed to The Nature Conservancy (TNC) who took title of it in 2006. That same year, TNC enlisted Potomac Valley Audubon Society (PVAS) to be the local stewards of the property.

TNC and PVAS continue to work together to fulfill the Zapoleon's vision for Eidolon. We invite visitors from near and far to explore this enchanting place.

Wander the Trails *(map on next page)*

Over 4 miles of marked trails will carry you through Eidolon, and there is much to see. The elevation at the preserve's highest point is about 1,650 feet where you will find sweeping views of neighboring mountain ranges and the Potomac River.

Like much of the land in this area, Eidolon has been used heavily over the centuries. You will come upon stone piles where fields were cleared long ago for planting crops, the remains of quarries that provided stone for the C&O Canal in the 1840s, and a track of an old coach road whose usage dates back to the 1780s.

The preserve is now mostly forest, with oaks and maples predominating, and it provides habitat that supports a wide variety of plant and animal species such as the threatened cerulean warbler.

Taking the Ardalia Trail and Zapoleon Loop will take you from the bottom to the top of the mountain and give you the greatest glimpse of Eidolon's history and beauty. We hope you will take the time to fully explore all the wonders of this special place.



Eidolon Nature Preserve
Open Dawn to Dusk
2146 Orleans Road, Great Cacapon, WV 25422
(about 10 miles from Berkeley Springs)
Please park outside the green gated entrance.
For more information, please visit
www.potomacaudubon.org/preserves/eidolon

Water/Sewer Information

Warm Springs Public Service District

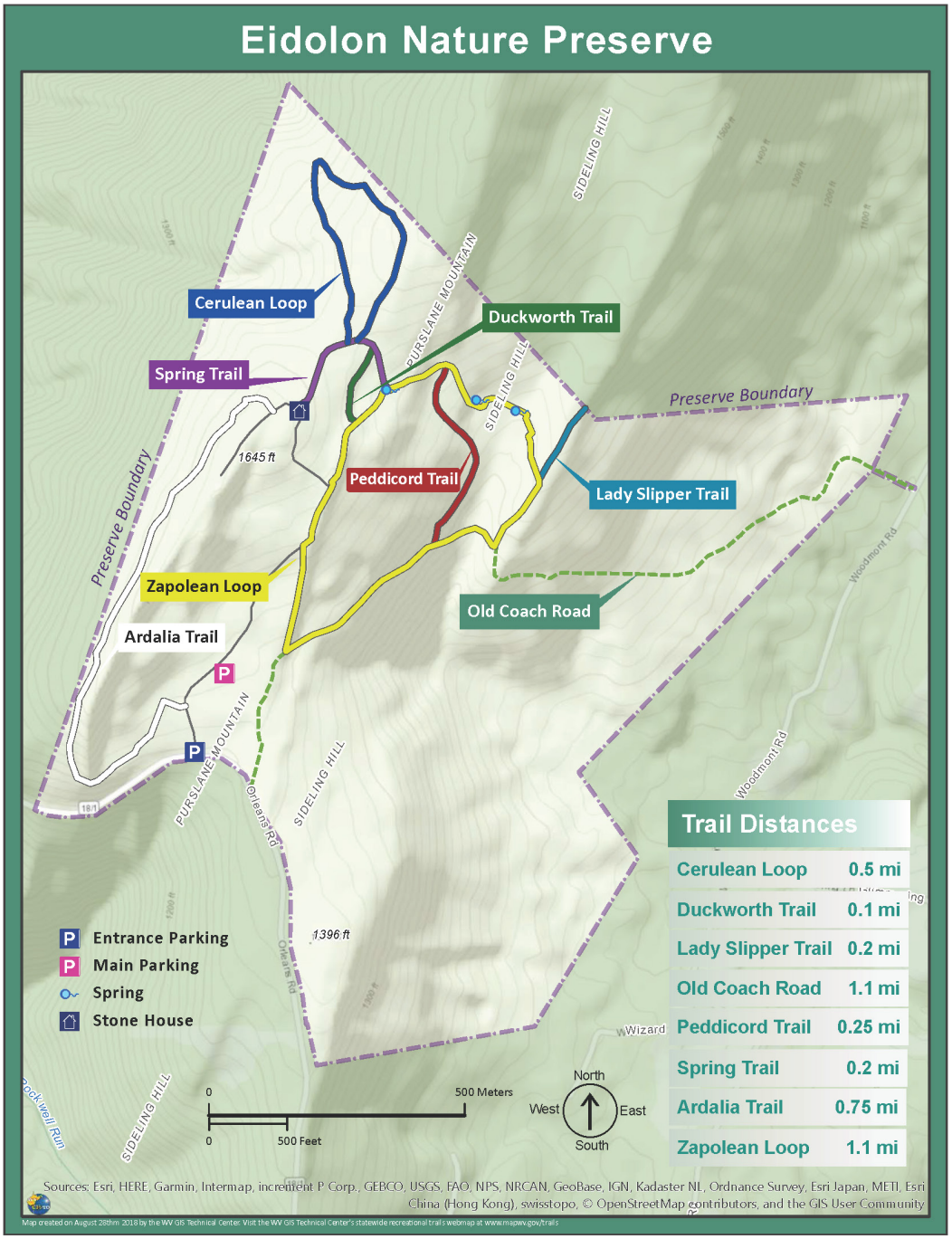
Weekdays, 9:00 am to 5:00 pm:
304-258-4118

All other times Morgan County non-emergency: 304-258-0305

Provide your name, address, lot number, and the nature of the issue.

MISSING GROUP EMAILS?

If you're not receiving the Google Group messages in your inbox, they may be diverting to your spam/junk folder. To help prevent this, create a record in your Contacts for the CMA Google Group. Set the contact email to **cma-members@googlegroups.com**. That should make your mail software recognize the CMA Google Group as a safe sender. When all else fails, you can read the posts online at groups.google.com/g/cma-members.



Coolfont Community Pool

LAST CHANCE! MAKE A SPLASH!

Just a reminder:
The Community Pool will close for the season on Labor Day, Monday, September 6.



Nature loves Coolfont!
See if you can find this tree.
(Hint: Bluebird Lane)

Green Pea Falafel

submitted by Iris Melton, K-12



Ingredients

- ½ cup dried green split peas (ground to powder in spice grinder)
- 1 ½ cups frozen peas, thawed
- ½ cup red onion, chopped
- 1 tablespoon all-purpose flour or chickpea flour
- 2 tablespoons parsley, chopped
- 2 garlic cloves, chopped
- 1 teaspoon ground coriander
- 1 teaspoon ground cumin
- ½ teaspoon baking powder
- ¼ teaspoon cayenne pepper
- 1 tablespoon fresh lemon juice
- Red pepper flakes (optional)
- Salt
- Safflower or vegetable oil, for frying

Directions

1. Pulse the thawed peas a few times in a food processor. Then add powdered dried peas, red onion, flour, parsley, garlic, coriander, cumin, baking powder, cayenne, lemon juice, and salt, and process until combined.
2. Form into patties and refrigerate until firm (smaller patties cook quicker and crispier).
3. Heat a few inches of oil in a heavy pot over medium-high heat. To test the temperature, drop a small piece of falafel batter into the oil. It should sizzle immediately then turn golden brown in less than a minute. If you have a thermometer, the oil should be heated to 350 degrees.
4. When the oil is ready, pick up a falafel patty with a fork and gently lower it into the oil. Repeat with two more. After two minutes, turn the falafel to cook all sides until they are golden brown all around.
5. Remove the falafel from the oil and place on a paper towel to drain. Serve immediately with pita bread, tzatziki or minted yogurt sauce, and quick pickled red onion.

Tzatziki Sauce

Combine: 1 medium, grated and drained English cucumber, ½ teaspoon salt, ½ teaspoon pepper, fresh lemon juice from 1 lemon, ½ clove chopped fresh garlic, 1 cup plain Greek yogurt, ½ cup fresh dill, and ½ cup fresh mint. Add 2 tablespoons extra virgin olive oil and 1 teaspoon white vinegar. Mix well.

Minted Yogurt

Combine: fresh lemon juice from 1 lemon, 1 cup Greek yogurt, salt and pepper to taste, and ½ cup fresh mint leaves.

Quick Pickled Red Onion

Thinly slice a red onion. Combine ½ c apple cider vinegar, 1 tablespoon sugar (or honey or agave), one teaspoon of salt, and a cup of water. Place sliced onion in glass jar and pour liquid over it. Let sit at room temperature for 1 hour.

NOTE FROM IRIS: All quantities are negotiable. My first impulse when writing a recipe is just to substitute the word "some" for all measured/weighed quantities, but most people are not happy with that much uncertainty. Just alter the quantities to appeal to your personal taste. (Because, really, has anyone ever used only 2 cloves of garlic?) You'll never be able to recreate it exactly if you just use "some," but that's part of its charm, isn't it?

Directory Updates



Keep your Membership Directory current with the updates noted below. We will also update the PDF available on the CMA website.

Lots of new folks this quarter!

A-2 Christopher Stork — Mountainside Chalet
twostorks@gmail.com (443) 527-3277
Susan Stork
twostorks@gmail.com (443) 527-2042
Part Time Rental

D-1 Travis Martz — Angel's Watch
travis@martzlegal.com (240) 426-5675
Daniel Martz
dmartz79@hotmail.com (410) 212-0606
Part Time Rental

H-1 [New House name only] — The Big Chill

J-3 Warren Rosenfeld
warrenrosenfeldesq@gmail.com (240) 447-1451
Dana Rosenfeld
lynnrosenfeld1987@gmail.com (410) 652-8639
Part Time Residents

KS-4 Brian Wolfman — Wintergreen Retreat
bswolfman@yahoo.com (301) 814-2138
Shereen Arent
shereenarent@gmail.com (301) 758-5452
Part Time Residents

S-5 Chris Peabody
cpeabody61@gmail.com (301) 466-1136
Lisa Peabody
lisapeabody5@gmail.com (301) 873-1147
Part Time Residents

WOHOA
WEST VIRGINIA ORGANIZATION OF HOMEOWNERS ASSOCIATIONS
2021 MEMBER

Board Shorts

May 15 Board Meeting (via Teleconference)

- Approved minutes of March 13 Board Meeting
- Bluebird Lane improvedments completed and Knox Lock installed (Fire Department access)
- Pool plastering postponed to Spring 2022
- Entrance closure requirement for private roads discussed. Refered for legal opinion
- Neighborhood Watch noted they are in need of more volunteers
- Approved contract to replace roof and install gutters on 343 Bobcat Pumphouse/Reservoir
- Approved auto-start generator installation for 343 Bobcat Pumphouse/Reservoir

June 12 Board Meeting (via Teleconference)

- Approved minutes of May 15 Board meeting
- Reviewed bids for new playground equipment, tabled for more information

July - No Board Meeting

The next Board Meeting is Saturday, August 28 at 10am in the Barn.

Coolfont Mountainside Association

P.O. Box 418, Berkeley Springs, WV 25411

Board of Directors

coolfont.board@gmail.com
Jason Géno, President
Steve Katz, Vice President
Susan Betts, Secretary
Dawne Holz, Treasurer
Sharon Géno, Director
Eric Lienhard, Director
Cindy Van Meter, Director

Website

www.coolfontmountainside.org

Google Group Email

cma-members@googlegroups.com

Google Group Signup/Web

groups.google.com/g/cma-members

Facebook

www.facebook.com/groups/257606361406



COMMITTEES & CONTACTS

Our committees are staffed by volunteers. They welcome any assistance with projects and events. If you would like to help, please contact the committee chair.

Site Manager - Almost Heaven Property Mgmt
Holly Malcomb cmasitemanager@gmail.com
304-671-0882

Communications - Dawne Holz
Facebook - Dawne Holz
Google Group - Cindy Van Meter
703-532-6862 cndyvm@yahoo.com
Newsletter - Dawne Holz
703-362-6727 coolfont.news@gmail.com
Website - Jeff Stovall
850-339-5279 jefferson.stovall@gmail.com

DACC - Dennis Daisey
202-834-0180 dennis.daisey@gmail.com

Finance - Dawne Holz, CMA Treasurer
703-362-6727 dawneholz@gmail.com

Firewise - Heidi Splane
610-742-5774 heidianderic@comcast.net

Infrastructure Mapping - Tom Holz
703-627-9391 tlholz@me.com

Neighborhood Watch - Cathy Levey
304-258-5481 mccm2012@hotmail.com

Nominations/Elections - Rusty McCrady
240-723-5930 rusty.mccrady@gmail.com

Social - Holly Malcomb & Kathy Katz
304-671-0882 cmasitemanager@gmail.com
304-258-9329 kathyk717@aol.com

Welcome - Rosemary Bigelow
304-258-5352 rosemary@mygrandmotherslace.com

Water & Sewer

Chair - Cathy Levey
304-258-5481 mccm2012@hotmail.com

Warm Springs Public Svc Dist
Mon - Fri, 9:00 am - 5:00 pm: 304-258-4118
All other times: Morgan County 304-258-0305

Join the CMA Facebook group!
www.facebook.com/groups/257606361406